

Imagery Interventions



Precontemplation: Not intending to change in the next 6 months. Focus specific to imagery should be on imagining what a healthy lifestyle looks like.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Intake and Expenditure	Walk clients through an imagery exercise where they imagine the food they are eating versus the energy they are expending.
Similar Stories	Have clients recount a story verbally about a friend or relative who has unhealthy habits and how it has impacted their life. Have them include all senses possible and be as descriptive as possible with the story.
Fast Forward	Have clients imagine where they will be in 5 years and then in 10 years if they do not make healthy changes to their lifestyle. Have them close their eyes and imagine every aspect of the scenario (e.g., how they will physically feel, how their work life may change, which friends they surround themselves with).
Contemplation: Intending to change within the next 6 months. Focus specific to imagery should be on imagining what a healthy lifestyle looks like for the client.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
My Testimonial	Have clients imagine themselves 1 year from now as if they were able to accomplish all of the goals they set out to achieve. Have them either talk or write about it in the present tense, as if they were crafting a testimonial. Have them talk about all of the ways the new life has changed them (e.g., playing tirelessly with grandchildren, not craving fast food, feeling light).
Breaking Barriers	Have clients imagine and explain their greatest barrier to exercise. Then have them visualize overcoming that barrier and making it to their workout.
Preparation: Intending to change in the next month. Focus specific to imagery should be on imagining specific healthy activities.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
The Satisfying Meal	Have clients imagine preparing a healthy meal. Have them talk through what they are eating, how it smells, how it tastes, and how they feel satisfied afterward.
A Great Start	Have clients explain everything that will happen on that day to kick off the program right. Have them talk about all the senses associated with that day in great detail.

Imagery Interventions



Action: Just beginning to change. Focus specific to imagery should be on implementing imagery to facilitate a healthy lifestyle.

Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
The Daily Grind	Have clients imagine and recount minor challenges they face on a regular basis to put their plan in action and the ways in which they accomplish their goals.
The New Routine	Have clients talk or write about what their life looks like once they have entered the action stage. Have them provide as much detail as possible around what their new routine looks like and how they are able to maintain consistency.

Maintenance: In the process of change for 6 months. Focus specific to imagery should be on using imagery to maintain a healthy lifestyle.

Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
The Next Fitness Level	Have clients imagine what it looks like for them to take their fitness to the next level. Have them talk about how that will sustain their now-healthy lifestyle. Let clients talk as loftily or unrealistically as they like—just make sure they include as much detail as possible around the activity.
Removal of Resources	Have clients imagine a new type of barrier that impacts something such as time, money, stress, or motivation. Have them imagine what their days look like without their resource; have them imagine and talk through the ways in which they will preserve in light of their lacking resource.